Dear President Reagan:

I am the mother of L/Cpl David Cosner, killed recently in Lebanon.

I want to thank you for your kind letter sharing our grief. I know this was hard for you to do since you think everyone is blaming you for this tragedy. I was very angry at everyone, including you. I was not ready to give David up and I felt it was not *our* country he was keeping peace for.

As the 23rd of Oct. dragged on, I was constantly reminded that I had asked God to watch over him. I knew if he was safe, God was giving him strength to help his fallen buddies, but, if he was dead, I also know he would be at peace in God's arms. This turmoil continued until 9 P.M. The blessed peace and comfort came, telling me he was in his Heavenly Home.

I really believe it was simply David's destiny to have been there.

He was an excellent Marine and therefore had the *choice* of any base in the world. He chose to stay at Camp Lejeune knowing he was going to Lebanon.

He was not sent nor did he have to go. This is why I am telling you this so you will know that David did indeed give his most precious gift to America, very unselfishly, and some good must come of this tragedy.

He left us a beautiful 2½ year old granddaughter, Leanna, and wonderful memories from the 22 years we shared.

I am so proud to be David's mother and I know in time I will get the hugs from him that are denied me now.

I have asked our wonderful town to stand behind you, our chosen leader, so our enemies will know we are strong. One Nation, Under God.